

## Responding to an NEA brief

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### 1 Preparatory Activities (non-assessed)

Even though there are no marks attached to the preparatory activities, it is essential for learners to carry out these activities in preparation for their production task so that each individual learner's work can be authenticated. Failure to carry out sufficient research into relevant genres and media forms as well as adequately plan a chosen production is also likely to restrict a learner's ability to meet the higher levels of the marking criteria.

#### 1 (a) Research

In preparation for the production task, learners should carry out research into professionally produced media products that are similar in genre, style and form to the media products proposed in their chosen production brief. Learners should deconstruct, analyse and make notes on these professionally produced media products so that they can further develop knowledge and understanding of their chosen media form's distinctive media language, for example:

- how genre conventions are employed
- how and why intertextuality is employed
- how combinations of media language elements are used to create meaning and construct representations that address an intended audience.

Learners should be prepared to analyse the distinctive media language elements appropriate to the brief chosen, listed below:

#### **Moving image (television/music video) as part of a cross-media brief:**

- camerawork
- editing
- soundtrack
- mise en scène.

#### **Radio as part of a cross-media brief:**

- use of music
- use of voice
- use of sound effects.

### Magazines as part of a cross-media brief:

- layout
- typography
- use of language
- use of images.

### Online media as part of a cross-media brief:

- layout
- navigation
- use of language
- use of images/text/audio/video.

## 1 (b) Planning

Learners should produce planning materials for their individual NEA cross-media production which outline the intentions of their final production. Centres are encouraged to explore appropriate ways of producing relevant planning materials based upon their own strengths and resources.

The following list of planning materials is purely indicative:

- draft script
- storyboard
- location report(s)
- notes on casting and mise-en-scène considerations
- mock-up of a print advert layout or mock-up of a webpage
- rough cuts/drafts
- audience research and feedback.

## 2 The NEA brief

Learners must choose one from a choice of four production briefs. Centres are advised to consider the resources and equipment that they have available for learners to employ in this component when deciding upon choice of production briefs.

Learners must choose **one** of the following:

- a television and online cross-media brief
- a magazine and online cross-media brief

- a radio and online cross-media brief
- a music video and online cross-media brief.

The set NEA briefs will be published on the OCR website on the 1<sup>st</sup> March each year for submission in the following academic year.

### Statement of Intent

Learners **must** complete a Statement of Intent for their cross-media production which **must** be submitted with their production. A penalty will be applied if it is not supplied to the teacher with a learner's final production (see Section 3i of this specification for more details). The Statement of Intent needs to outline the ways in which the learner proposes to link their media products to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of the digitally convergent nature of their production. The Statement of Intent also needs to outline the ways in which the learner proposes to use the four areas of the media theoretical framework to communicate meaning and meet the requirements of their chosen brief, set by OCR.

Learners must complete the Statement of Intent using approximately 500 words. A template will be provided on the OCR website for guidance.

### Length of individual production work

The lengths specified in the 'Requirements of the brief' section for each individual production (e.g. 3 minutes for a television extract and a home page and one linked web page for the online product etc.) are sufficient to give learners the opportunity to fully address all of the marking criteria. Learners should aim to produce work of the specified length. If work is submitted that is longer than the specified length, only the part up to (and including) the specified length can be credited. Any work beyond this must not be considered for credit against the marking criteria. Work that is shorter than the specified length should be marked against the marking criteria but may not allow learners to access the full range of marking criteria. See Section 3i of this specification for more details.

## Individual production rules

The responses to the OCR set briefs must be undertaken by learners as individuals and all materials must be assessed individually.

However, a learner may make use of unassessed students and others as long as the outcome can be assessed as the work of an individual learner.

For example, others may act in, or appear in, the media product. In addition, unassessed students and others may operate lighting, sound, recording and other equipment under the direction of the assessed **learner** if required. The learner **must**, however, have creative control, as director, and create the final edit of any moving image or radio production piece or edit the photos and write all copy for the print productions. The contribution of any unassessed learners should be clearly indicated on the NEA cover sheet.

Learners are recommended to be given approximately 30 hours of lesson time in which to complete their NEA productions (this total does not include preparatory research and planning). It should be noted that excessive time spent on this component in the classroom could be detrimental to the overall attainment of the learner and teachers should be mindful of striking a balance between the completion of the NEA and preparation for the examined components.

Where NEA briefs require a 'working website', learners are not required to create websites through programming languages such as HTML and can use web design software or templates. However, learners must be responsible for the design of the website and all content (such as text, images and audio-visual material) must be original. Learners must acknowledge any software or templates they have used on the cover sheet.

## NEA portfolio requirements

In summary each individual learner's completed NEA portfolio will consist of the following:

1. non-assessed research notes and planning materials to aid the authentication of work
2. Statement of Intent
3. a teacher assessed cross-media production
4. a non-exam assessment cover sheet that clearly indicates the contribution of any unassessed learners used. This should be completed by the teacher.

In addition, centres complete the CCS160 form, see Section 4d for further details.

## Assistance with productions

It is expected that teachers will train learners in the use of technology for their NEA productions and that centres will provide the necessary equipment for learners to produce their NEA productions.

## Further Guidance

Further guidance on authentication of learners' work, including details of level of supervision and allowable feedback can be found in Section 4d of this specification.

## Marking NEA Productions

The marking criteria for this component can be found in Section 3i of this specification.

## Suitability of NEA Productions

Teachers should use their professional judgement to determine the suitability of the content of learners' NEA productions.

Learners' NEA productions **may not** contain:

- gratuitous violence
- frequent use of strong language and swearing
- nudity
- imitation of dangerous behaviour
- scenes demonstrating or promoting drug taking
- material that could be considered offensive on the grounds of race or gender.